

SOUTH SHORE STATION
(11th Street Station)
114 East 11th Street
Michigan City
La Porte County
Indiana

HABS IN-325
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PHOTOGRAPHS

WRITTEN HISTORICAL AND DESCRIPTIVE DATA

FIELD RECORDS

HISTORIC AMERICAN BUILDINGS SURVEY
National Park Service
Interior Regions 3, 4, and 5
U.S. Department of the Interior
601 Riverfront Drive
Omaha, NE 68102

HISTORIC AMERICAN BUILDINGS SURVEY

SOUTH SHORE STATION

(11th Street Station)

HABS No. IN-325

- Location:** 114 E. 11th Street. Michigan City, La Porte County, Indiana.
- Present Owner and Occupant:** City of Michigan City; vacant.
- Significance:** The South Shore Station (also called the 11th Street Station) is significant under Criterion A as the earliest, if not the only, purpose-built, multi-modal transportation facility of the early twentieth century in La Porte County, Indiana. The South Shore Station was a central transportation hub, serving both rail and bus passengers, as well as freight lines. The Shore Line Motor Coach Company, which operated out of the Michigan City station, ran 26 bus routes in northern Indiana, southern Michigan, and Illinois. The station is furthermore representative of Samuel Insull's investment in and transformation of the Chicago South Shore & South Bend Railroad (CSS & SB), also known as the South Shore Line (SSL). The building is one of two extant early twentieth century stations of the SSL, both designed by Arthur Gerber. The South Shore Station is also significant under Criterion C as an example of Gerber's train stations in the greater Chicago area and is indicative of the Beaux Arts style that he characteristically employed in his designs for stations along the Chicago Rapid Transit Line. The South Shore Station is a contributing resource to the Franklin Street Commercial Historic District, listed in the National Register of Historic Places (NRHP) under Criteria A and C.

PART 1. HISTORICAL INFORMATION

A. Physical History:

1. Date of erection: 1926
2. Architect: Arthur Gerber.
3. Original and subsequent owners, uses:
 - a. The original owner was Samuel Insull. The station was constructed after Insull's purchase of the CSS & SB, and was part of Insull's major

modernization and improvement plan for the SSL that included new luxury cars, electrical equipment, and station buildings.¹

- b. The Great Depression caused Insull's railroad companies to fall into bankruptcy, and the SSL entered receivership in 1933. New management took over operation of the line until 1938, when the SSL re-emerged from receivership.²
- c. As passenger service on the SSL declined after World War II, the station fell into disuse and disrepair. It was largely abandoned in the mid-1970s and was sold as part of the bankruptcy proceedings of the SSL in the 1980s.³
- d. In 1998, a group of Chicago developers purchased the station with the intention of converting it to condominiums and commercial space; however, those plans never materialized and the building remained vacant.⁴
- e. Later in 1998, the building was transferred to LaPorte County Sheriff Michael F. Mollenhauer (no sale price is listed).⁵
- f. In 2013, the building was sold to George P. Xidias and remained vacant.⁶
- g. Later in 2013, the building was sold to Wal-Dawg Endeavors, LLC and remained vacant.⁷
- h. In 2014, the building was sold to Campo Development Group, LLC and remained vacant.⁸

¹ William D. Middleton, *South Shore: The Last Interurban* (Bloomington: IU Press, 1970), 65.

² American-rail.com, "Chicago, South Shore and South Bend Railroad: 'The South Shore Line,'" American-Rails.com website, <https://www.american-rails.com/csssb.html>, accessed April 2020.

³ Tom Burke, "Insull's Architect," *Locomotive & Railway Preservation* (Pasadena, CA: Pentrex Inc, 1996), Issue 58, March-April, 44-46.

⁴ Ibid.

⁵ Information regarding recent ownership history acquired through the Beacon, a local government GIS tax lot search website. Beacon 2020, "Local Government GIS for the Web," <https://beacon.schneidercorp.com/?site=La%20PorteCountyIN>, accessed March 2020.

⁶ Ibid.

⁷ Ibid.

⁸ Ibid.

- i. In 2017, the City of Michigan City purchased the building and remains the current owner. Since the city acquired the building it has remained vacant.⁹

4. Builder: CSS & SB.

5. Original plans and construction: The original exterior of the South Shore Station building remains largely intact. The original design for the facility included a rectangular, two-story station wing with a full basement, attached to a one-story brick bus garage on the east side. The garage, which was designed and constructed under a separate contract with The Austin Company and Stefco Steel Company, extended east across the remainder of the city block to Pine Street. Connecting the two-story, terracotta station to the one-story bus garage was a one-story brick bay that contained the baggage room, concession storage, restrooms, smoke rooms, and stair cases to the second story (the enclosed stairwell extended to the second floor beyond the roof of the one-story brick bay) and basement levels of the station.

The two-story terracotta station is three bays wide, with the façade oriented southeast, and covered in glazed architectural terracotta. The terracotta is reinforced by load-bearing brick walls. Interior structural framing consists of wood joists and steel I-beams and lintels supported on steel pipe columns. The terracotta façade features Beaux Arts ornamentation including a pedimented parapet with a central oculus, heavy molded cornice, and laurel wreath and swags on corner pilasters. A full basement under the two-story block is finished with a concrete floor and fitted with concrete and cast iron sewer and drainage systems, a heating system, a wash room in the northwest corner, and restrooms.

On the first floor of the two-story terracotta station, entry and exit doors are located on the façade and rear (northwest) walls. The original entrance appears to be mostly unaltered, consisting of 7' four-leaf glazed wood doors with 4'5"-high plate glass transom windows. The current doors and transom windows are likely these original components. The front doors are flanked by two large storefront window openings, originally filled with single sheets of plate glass (now replaced). The second floor façade of the building was covered with a continuous band of seven pairs of metal casement windows, each pair capped by a rectangular transom window, the total window opening height extending 8'6". Fenestration on the rear (northwest) of the station consisted originally of fixed, square-light wood windows on the first floor and single, double-hung wood sash

⁹ Ibid.

arranged evenly across the second floor. A four-leaf glazed wood door with transom, matching the façade entrance configuration, was centered on the rear, first floor wall of the two-story station wing. Original rear fenestration has mostly been replaced or infilled, though cement and terrazzo sills remain intact. The two-story station wing is capped with a flat roof, very slightly pitched upwards towards the front (southeast) terracotta parapet.

The one-story brick hyphen on the east side of the two-story station remains intact, its exterior ornamented with original brick veneer and cut stone lintel and cornice. The hyphen contains a separate façade entrance from the station, consisting of a three-leaf, wood-framed door with center lights, capped by a steel, divided-light transom window. The former hyphen constitutes the current east end of the station building, and projects horizontally and vertically where it contains the interior staircase. The hyphen was originally capped by two separate copper-encased skylight cupolas aligned above the interior staircases. These cupolas referenced a larger skylight that stretched across the roof of the adjacent bus garage.

The interior of the original two-story station was open in plan on all three levels (including basement), and the bay division on the terracotta façade continued through the interior, marked by cement plaster columns set into composition bases on the asbestos-cement (abestone) tiled floor.

6. Alterations and additions: Abandoned in February 1976 for a new municipal maintenance garage, the formerly attached one-story brick bus garage was subsequently demolished.¹⁰

Inspections conducted in the station interior and exterior in 1988 and 2017 show that much of the original fenestration on the first story of the building has been altered or replaced. On the façade, the original plate glass storefront windows were replaced with a combination of glass block and large glass panels set in aluminum framing (ca. 1970), and were boarded shut with composition paneling ca. 2000.¹¹ On the second story of the façade, the original metal casement windows were replaced at an unknown date with a band of 14 wood casement windows stacked over a corresponding band of 14 double-hung one-over-one-light wood-sash windows. Glass lights are missing or broken in many locations. Windows are boarded on the exterior. Rear doors on the station were replaced

¹⁰ Michigan City Public Library (MCPL), Clipping from *Michigan City News-Dispatch* dated February 4, 1976, MCPL South Shore Railroad vertical files.

¹¹ Ann C. Davis, *LaPorte County Interim Report: Indiana Historic Sites and Structures Survey* (Indianapolis: Historic Landmarks Foundation, 1989).

with modern infill, and both doors located on the façade (primary station entrance and east hyphen entrance) were boarded ca. 2000. These two entrances remain structurally intact and potentially operative; however, the lights are broken or missing.

The rear bays of the southwest (side) wall, part of the one-story rear addition, contain two windows that were removed and boarded ca. 2000. In addition, a four-leaf entrance on this wall has been boarded, obscuring its exact configuration. It appears to consist of central double-leaf wood doors flanked by two wood-framed glazed doors. A large wood awning transom remains above the central doors, and wood casement transom windows sit above the side doors. The operational hardware is intact, and the windows appear to be operational. All fenestration on this southwest wall has been boarded on the exterior.

The northwest (rear) wall retains an operable set of modern double-leaf doors, which are set in the original opening and flanked by two single-leaf doors. Above the entrance remains the original wood transom windows, which appear to be awning and/or casement, and have been boarded on the exterior. Original square-light fixed wood windows are located just below ceiling level to either side of the rear entrance. These rear windows are boarded.

Between ca. 1970 and ca. 2000, the interior of the building was stripped of floor and ceiling material, as well as nearly all wall finishes, down to the original studs and brick load-bearing walls. Wall finishes that remain include minimal wood paneling and wood shelving located in the basement level. Structural components are exposed and some remaining electrical wiring is visible. None of the interior electrical or plumbing components appear operational, and most have been removed.

B. Historical Context:

The South Shore Station, constructed in 1926, is located at 114 E. 11th St. in Michigan City. A La Porte County survey rated the building Outstanding in 1989 for its architecture; in local terms of significance, Outstanding equates to individually eligible for the NRHP.¹² The building was evaluated for NRHP listing in 2017 and determined eligible under Criteria A and C. The building is also a contributing resource to the NRHP-listed Franklin Street Commercial Historic District. The two-story station received two additions ca. 1927-30. It remained in its original use until it

¹² Ibid. The South Shore Station is IHSSI (County Survey) Number 091-406-21092.

was vacated in the mid-1970s. Since that time, the building has been largely stripped on the interior with only structural members extant, and it remains vacant.

Michigan City was the first substantial urban center to develop on Indiana's Lake Michigan shore. The city was platted in 1832 by Isaac Elston of Crawfordsville, Indiana. The land platted by Elston lay at the surveyed north terminus of Michigan Road (today Michigan Boulevard), though the road was not actually built into the new town until the mid-1830s. Michigan Road was designed by the state of Indiana to be a north-south artery complementing the national east-west route through Indianapolis (an early predecessor to Interstate 70), and eventually extended north from Madison on the Ohio River, through Indianapolis, and terminated at Lake Michigan. State commissioners began surveying the road alignment at its north end, and located a suitable terminus at the mouth of Trail Creek, which seemed an ideal site for a harbor and town center. Along the approximately 100 miles between Trail Creek and the Wabash River, the new road ran initially eastward to touch the south bend of the St. Joseph River before bending due south.¹³ Once completed to Michigan City, Michigan Road terminated at the intersection of Michigan Street and Spring Street.

In 1850, the Michigan Central Railroad was built through Michigan City, connecting the city to Detroit, Buffalo, Albany, and the Eastern Seaboard cities. Two years later, the Monon Railroad (formally the Chicago, Indianapolis, and Louisville Railway) was built into Michigan City from the south. In 1871, the Indianapolis, Peru, and Chicago Railway completed a 159-mile-line connecting Indianapolis to Michigan City, entering the latter from the southeast before merging with the Michigan Central Railroad at the northeast corner of the city.¹⁴ The town became a railroad hub for the southeast Great Lakes region, a development reinforced by the continued expansion of its harbor. The Old Lighthouse, the oldest extant structure in Michigan City, was built in 1858, and the bridge over Trail Creek was removed in order to expand the harbor's capacity as a commercial shipping port. The upper harbor was dredged for the first time in 1867, and multiple times over in the following decades in order to allow for more and larger vessels carrying lumber, barrels, corn, wheat, beef, pork, fish, and other commercial goods.¹⁵ Industries in Michigan City included fishing and the manufacture of lumber, furniture, refrigerators, and railroad cars. Additionally, the Northern Indiana State Prison was constructed 1860-68 on 100 acres west of the city, and Zorn Brewery was established in 1871 by German immigrant Phillip Zorn.

¹³ Rollo B. Oglesbee and Albert Hale, *History of Michigan City, Indiana* (LaPorte, IN: E.J. Widdell, 1908), 69-70.

¹⁴ Richard S. Simons and Francis H. Parker, *Railroads of Indiana* (Bloomington and Indianapolis: Indiana University Press, 1997), 126-129.

¹⁵ MCPL, 2016, "Timeline of Michigan City," Electronic document, <http://www.mcpl.org/genealogy/chronology.html>; Oglesbee and Hale 1908, 111; 142.

One particularly prominent business in the town was the Haskell and Barker Car Company, established by industrialist John Barker, Sr. in 1855.¹⁶ The factory became the largest manufacturing plant in the state, and was renowned for producing the PS-1 steel box car, which became the standardized model for the railroad cars. By 1900, the plant covered 40 acres of land and employed over 1,600 workers; by the end of the next decade, the car company had sprawled to cover 100 acres, and employed a workforce of 3,500 men. The residential Haskell and Barker Historic District (NR-2339) bordered the industrial complex on its western side.

Michigan City's commercial district initially developed at around the juncture of Franklin and Front Streets near the harbor, which was the early center of growth for the city. Commercial construction was concentrated along Front Street for the first 20 years after the town's establishment. The coming of the railroad in the 1850s forced the eventual closing of Front Street, and subsequent commercial growth spread southward down Franklin Street. Originally a residential neighborhood, Franklin Street was the first in the city to install sidewalks in 1840, and the first to be planked in 1850. Horse-drawn street cars provided city transportation along Franklin Street by 1881, and lines were electrified 10 years later. An electric interurban was built out of the city to LaPorte in 1903, and the South Shore interurban line was completed along 11th Street in 1908.¹⁷

The original plat of Michigan City was enlarged on the east and west sides during the 1850s. The Michigan City Land Company developed much of Elston's original plat, as well as many of the later additions. Two of the city's earliest residential neighborhoods are located within Elston Grove Historic District (NR-2331) and Haskell and Barker Historic District, historically also known (in part) as the Washington Street district. The Elston Grove neighborhood historically included two separately platted sections. The west end belonged to Isaac Elston's original town plat. The rest of the district was platted a few years later by the Michigan Land Company.¹⁸ Primarily residential in character, Elston Grove also contained many of the city's early public buildings, including the high school and library. The Zorn Brewery, a major local industry in the city, was constructed in Elston Grove in 1877.

The railroad and industrial development of the late nineteenth century ushered in a new era of prosperity for the town, evidenced by the presence of houses built in higher style and larger form. More elaborate residence styles dating from the late nineteenth and early twentieth century in Michigan City include two and three-story

¹⁶ Don Manaher, *A Pictorial History of Michigan City, Indiana 1675-1992* (Marceline, MO: Heritage House Publishing, 1992), 44.

¹⁷ Davis 1989, 15; Sheridan 1926, 10.

¹⁸ Davis 1989, 26.

Queen Anne, Italianate, Colonial and Classical Revival, and Craftsman. More modest front-gable homes, bungalows, duplexes, and apartments continued to be built during this period as well, accommodating an ever-growing population of industrial workers. Immigrants in Michigan City left their ethnic and cultural imprint in their buildings, particularly in their religious architecture. Circa 1911, the Syrian-Americans built an Orthodox church at the corner of Grace and Holliday Streets, on the eastern fringes of town. German and Polish workers were especially numerous, and were prolific in establishing churches, schools, and social buildings. The Poles built St. Stanislaus Catholic Church in 1892; the current brick Romanesque Revival edifice was constructed on the site of the original church in 1926. Germans founded St. Paul's Lutheran Church, built on Franklin Street in the Gothic Revival style in 1876, and a year later built the St. Johannes Verein building, a social and shopping center for German immigrants.¹⁹

Supported in large part by immigrant labor, Michigan City flourished as an industrial and transportation hub in the early twentieth century. The year 1903 heralded the arrival of electric railways to Michigan City, with the construction by the Chicago and South Shore Railway Company of an interurban line extending north from LaPorte to Michigan City, as well as a downtown streetcar that ran the length of Franklin Street.²⁰ The Northern Indiana Railway Company acquired both lines in 1905. Three years later, the South Shore interurban line opened, connecting South Bend to Chicago and running through the center of Michigan City along 11th Street.²¹ The same decade saw establishment of new factories in Michigan City, including the Chair Factory on the site of the former Alaska Refrigerator Company, and the Kronthal and Company (or B. Kronthal & Co.) Shirt Factory, which later housed the Michigan City Paper Box Company, at the corner of Detroit and Pine Streets. Residential neighborhoods with schools and churches often developed around major place of employment such as these.

Industrial and urban development in northwestern Indiana during the early twentieth century owed much to the enterprising South Shore Line (SSL), which fed cities, factories, and harbors with an essential and steady flow of workers and freight. The Chicago South Shore & South Bend (CSS & SB; later renamed the South Shore Line) originated as part of the Chicago, Lake Shore & South Bend Railway (CLS & SB, or Lake Shore Line), which had been chartered in 1901 as the Chicago & Indiana Air Line Railroad in 1901. The line was extended eastward in 1906 to the new company town of Gary, Indiana, following the establishment of the United States Steel

¹⁹ Ibid, 16.

²⁰ Oglesbee and Hale 1908,136.

²¹ Middleton 1970, 13; Kevin J. Holland, *Chicago South Shore & South Bend in Color: Volume I – Sixty Years of the South Shore* (South Plains, NJ: Morning Sun Books, Inc., 2005).

Corporation's steel mill, Gary Works.²² Two years later, the line was extended through Michigan City to South Bend, and by 1912 the line (then the Lake Shore Line) was providing passenger service to and from Chicago via seven daily trains completing each one-way trip in 1 hour and 15 minutes.²³ The train's route from Chicago to South Bend constituted a true interurban, a railway traveling literally "between cities".²⁴

In 1926, Midwestern utilities baron Samuel Insull purchased the Lake Shore Line, and renamed it the Chicago, South Shore, and South Bend Line. Under Insull's ownership, the SSL underwent a massive improvement scheme that included new steel cars, improvements to the distribution system, and installation of new electrical equipment. The first SSL station in Michigan City, which had occupied a store building on 11th Street, was replaced under the prosperous domain of Insull with a new depot building designed in the Beaux Arts style by Arthur Gerber in 1927.²⁵ The station stood on 11th Street, and served as a joint bus-rail station and the main transfer stop between SSL trains and the subsidiary Shore Line Motor Coach Company buses. Gerber was Insull's chief railway architect and civil engineer who designed dozens of railway stations in the Chicago area. Along the SSL, Gerber also designed new stations at South Bend (1928) and Beverly Shores (1929). The South Bend terminal reflected the Beaux Arts style Gerber applied in Michigan City, and Beverly Shores still stands as a typical example of Gerber's Spanish Colonial Revival type, which he built frequently, especially along the Chicago North Shore & Milwaukee Railway (North Shore Line).²⁶ Samuel Insull also incorporated a subsidiary bus system, the Shore Line Motor Coach Company, which operated out of the Michigan City terminal and extended eventually as far north as Grand Rapids, Michigan. By 1926, the Shore Line Motor Coach operated 26 routes in northern Indiana, southern Michigan, and Illinois.²⁷

The first few years of Insull's ownership was the zenith period for the SSL. The railway doubled its annual passenger traffic from just over 1.5 million in 1925 to nearly 3 million in 1928. Complementing but also competing with the rail lines was the automobile industry, which entered a period of major growth during the 1920s. A new wave of road building and improvement, spurred by the Great Roads Movement,

²² Ronald D. Cohen and Stephen G. McShane, eds., *Moonlight in Duneland: The Illustrated Story of the Chicago South Shore and South Bend Railroad* (Bloomington and Indianapolis: IU Press), 1998; Nancy Coltun Webster, "South Shore a Commuter Rail Survivor," (Chicago: *Chicago Post-Tribune*), June 17, 2016.

²³ Joyce Russell, "Ogden Dunes Grew on Industrialization, Conservation," (Munster, IN: *The Times of Northwest Indiana*), March 13, 2016.

²⁴ Simons and Parker 1997, 42.

²⁵ Middleton 1970, 44.

²⁶ Ibid, 65; Burke 1996, 44-46.

²⁷ Middleton 1970, 53.

resulted in an unprecedented network of paved and divided auto roads connecting small towns, cities, and interstate regions. U.S. 12, also called the Iron Brigade Highway or the Dunes Highway, was an early automobile road built mostly along the Calumet Beach trail, a Native American trail that was gradually improved for wagons and buggies after Euro-American settlement.²⁸ U.S. 12 was designated a U.S. Highway in 1926. The road guided the alignment for the SSL, which runs directly alongside it from Gary to Michigan City (the two roads diverge at Michigan City, with U.S. 12 continuing northeast along the lakeshore and the CSS & SB tracks angling due east to South Bend). U.S. 20, or the Dunes Relief Highway, was constructed in 1931-32 as part of a nationwide east-west route. Unlike U.S. 12, which followed a centuries-old path, U.S. 20 was constructed largely on uncharted ground. As its name suggests, the Dunes Relief Highway's parallel location south of U.S. 12 provided an alternate traffic route along Lake Michigan's busy south shore. Decades prior to the construction of the interstates through northwest Indiana, the two parallel U.S. highways were reportedly the busiest roads in the state, particularly during the World's Fair in Chicago in 1933-34.²⁹

Growth and prosperity in Michigan City and along the SSL dwindled in the 1930s during the Great Depression. During this time, the SSL relied heavily on freight traffic, three-quarters of which was coal, most headed to fuel Insull's utilities operations. Hard times notwithstanding, a Sanborn Fire Insurance map shows that sometime between 1929 and 1936, the second floor of the South Shore Station was used as a dance hall.³⁰ An outdoor dance hall had existed at Doll's Park, on the southwest corner of Carroll Avenue and Michigan Boulevard, since ca. 1910, and in 1927, the upscale Oasis Ballroom opened in the Lakeview Casino. The Oasis was reportedly one of the largest dance halls in the Midwest, with a capacity for over 2,400 people.³¹ The South Shore Station dance hall may have provided a more casual wintertime dance venue alternative. It is unknown how long the second floor of the station was used for this purpose.

World War II revived the city's economy, bringing about new demands for industrial production and transportation, both of which Michigan City was well equipped to provide. During the 1940s, both freight and passenger revenues rebounded, spiking to

²⁸ Dale B. Engquist and Kenneth R. Raithel, Jr., *US 12 Scenic Road Feasibility Study: Indiana Dunes National Lakeshore, Indiana*, 1991, Electronic document, https://archive.org/stream/us12scenicroadfe00nati/us12scenicroadfe00nati_djvu.txt.

²⁹ Sally S. Nalbor, "U.S. 20 Handled Overload of Dunes Visitors," (Munster, IN: *Northwest Indiana Times*), May 30, 1999, Electronic document, http://www.nwitimes.com/uncategorized/u-s-handled-overload-of-dunes-visitors/article_34f6ef22-2331-5f0a-ab33-598bfad9211e.html.

³⁰ Sanborn Map Company, *Insurance Maps of Michigan City, Indiana, LaPorte County* (New York: Sanborn Map Company, 1936), sheet 9.

³¹ MCPL, "Timeline of Michigan City," MCPL website, <https://www.mcplib.org/explore-topics/local-history/timeline-of-michigan-city/>, accessed May 2020.

all-time highs during World War II. The SSL served as a critical means of freight transport for the industrial wartime products generated en masse in Michigan City, Gary, and the Chicago area. Additionally, passenger volume rose steadily each year of the war, doubling in number between 1941 and 1943, and reaching an all-time high of over six million in 1945. The sudden boom in activity and carriage necessitated a rebuilding program for the 1920s-era cars and rail line.³² Improvements to the rail cars were carried out locally in Michigan City, and consisted of lengthening and strengthening car underframes, installing new seating, florescent lighting, air conditioning, VHF radio, and larger picture windows.³³ The end of the war brought about a gradual decline in industry and in railroads.

PART 2. ARCHITECTURAL INFORMATION

A. General Statement

1. Architectural character: The South Shore Station is a two-story commercial building with a roughly rectangular plan, augmented by two rear and side additions. The Beaux Arts-style building façade is three bays wide and oriented southeast. The building is constructed of architectural glazed terracotta on the façade, reinforced with interior steel framing and backed by a brick load-bearing wall, and brick load-bearing side and rear walls, also supported with interior wood and steel framing.

The building foundation is composed of board-formed concrete that includes a full basement. The basement is supported by steel columns that separate the three main bays. The brick walls of the first and second stories are supported by interior wood and steel framing, including at all fenestration openings. The building has a flat roof obstructed by a pedimented terracotta parapet, which is ornamented with an oculus, laurel wreath, and swags. A heavy terracotta cornice with egg and dart and corbel moldings extends across the façade and wraps around the corners of the building. Corners feature engaged paneled pilasters embellished with laurel swags. A wide paneled frieze on the façade separates the upper story, banded and stacked double-hung wood sash windows, from the first story. The first story originally had a large double-leaf center entry flanked by full-height sidelights and capped by a transom. The entry was additionally flanked by large full-height commercial glass windows. All openings on the façade of the station are currently boarded. The entry is flanked by pilasters that are capped by elongated pentagons with laurel swags.

³² Middleton 1970, 152-154.

³³ Ibid, 75-79.

A large, one-story brick addition is located on the rear (northwest) wall of the building, largely obscured from the public right-of-way (ROW). It has a flat roof that is pierced by a brick chimney in the southeast corner of the addition. The addition likely dates to soon after the station was constructed to accommodate increased freight service (ca. 1927-30). A smaller, one-story, one-bay brick addition is also located on the northeast wall. The one-story mass is the only extant portion of the one-story brick bus garage that was constructed on the east side of the station in 1927. Abandoned in February 1976 for a new municipal maintenance garage, the bus garage was subsequently demolished.³⁴ This remaining portion of the garage retains a multi-leaf entrance with metal awning windows, all currently boarded.

Much of the first-story façade fenestration was removed or altered between ca. 1970 and ca. 2000. The primary entrance on the façade is boarded and inoperable. The only operable exterior door on the building dates to ca. 2000 and is located on the northwest (rear) wall.

2. Condition of Fabric: The condition of the station building is poor to moderate. Structurally, the brick and terracotta walls and concrete foundation are sound; however, exterior terracotta units and moldings are spalling and chipped, and the fenestration and building interior are in poor condition. The terracotta detailing is in fair condition as pieces of tile and metal structural anchors show visible signs of deterioration and rust. Some of the terracotta units exhibit cracking. The cracks are generally tight (hairline) and orientated predominantly in the vertical direction; however, one relatively wide crack is noted on the façade, and several open joints were observed at various locations at the façade. Some of the terracotta mortar joints are missing, and it appears that flexible sealant has been installed to seal the exterior side of the joints at several street-level locations. Where sealant was observed in the joints, it was severely distressed. Some of the terracotta units also exhibit pitting and spalling. Lastly, some of the steel members that support the parapet wall at the roof level have begun to rust. Window frames are mostly intact, and many appear operative; however, glass lights are missing or broken, and all windows on the façade are boarded. Interior finishes have been mostly removed.

³⁴ Michigan City Public Library (MCPL), Clipping from Michigan City *News-Dispatch* dated February 4, 1976, MCPL South Shore Railroad vertical files.

B. Description of Exterior

1. Overall Dimensions: The building has a footprint of approximately 100' in the north-south direction (depth) x 50' in the east-west direction (width). The second level has a lesser footprint of 60' north-south (depth) x 50' east-west (width).
2. Foundations: The building has a board-formed and poured concrete foundation consisting of full-height perimeter walls enclosing a basement level and a solid slab at the floor of the basement.
3. Walls: The building façade is constructed of load-bearing architectural glazed terracotta, hung on steel and wood framing components. The terracotta parapet is reinforced with brick and steel rods on the backside. The exterior side and rear walls of the building are load-bearing brick, stacked in a five-course common bond.
4. Structural System, Framing: The building façade is constructed of architectural terracotta units, hung to framing with steel rods and hooks, and backed by a brick interior wall. The exterior northeast and southwest brick walls are also load-bearing walls, supporting interior wood joists. The interior structural framing consists of 2" x 12" wood joists spanning in the northeast-southwest direction between interior northeast-southwest steel I-beams that vary in size and are supported by steel pipe columns. Steel pipe columns within the terracotta façade on the southeast side of the building support the southern ends of the northeast-southwest steel beams. Steel lintel beams also support the façade above the windows and entry door on the interior. Those beams support the terracotta and brick masonry above the wall openings. Pilasters are installed on each side of the main entrance and at the southeast and southwest corners of the building. They consist of brick masonry with decorative terracotta facing.
5. Stairways: There are no exterior stairways, and the building is accessed from the ground level on the first story.
6. Chimneys: There is one brick chimney stack located within the northwest addition within the first story.
7. Openings:
 - a. Doorways and doors:

Façade (southeast)

Both doors located on the façade were boarded on the exterior ca. 2000. The primary entry consists of a set of double-leaf wood doors, each leaf with an inset glass light (one is broken); wood sidelights that are missing their inset lights; and a three-part upper transom. One light within the transom is broken. The secondary entrance on the façade (within the northeast addition) consists of a multi-leaf wood-paneled doors; and an 18-light metal awning transom, which has 6 missing or broken lights.

Southwest Wall

The southwest wall appears to contain central double-leaf wood doors flanked by two wood-framed glass doors. A large wood awning transom remains above the central doors, and wood casement transom windows sit above the side doors. The operational hardware is intact, and the windows appear to be operational. All fenestration on this southwest wall has been boarded on the exterior.

Northwest Wall:

Circa 2000, a set of steel doors was inserted into the first story. These modern doors exhibit simple steel framing that sits within the original wood-framed door openings. The original opening accommodates four door leafs, with the two outer doors boarded shut. The center modern set of doors is the only operable exterior entrance located on the building.

An additional door is located on the northwest wall and was boarded on the exterior ca. 2000. The single-leaf wood door has an inset glass light and an operable single-light transom. The door appears intact though not operable.

b. Windows:

Façade (southeast)

On the façade, original storefront windows on the first story were replaced with a combination of glass block and large glass panels set in aluminum framing (ca. 1970) and were later covered on the exterior with wood boards ca. 2000.

On the second story facade, 14 wood casement windows are stacked over 14 one-over-one-light double—hung, wood-sash windows. Windows appear to rest in original frames and surrounds, though many lights are broken or missing.

Southwest Wall

The rear bays of the southwest wall, within the addition, contain two windows that were removed and infilled with wood sheets ca. 2000.

Northwest Wall

Circa 1970, one window on the northwest wall was replaced with an aluminum-framed glass light and glass block. Circa 2000, six wood sash windows were replaced along the northwest wall on the second story with modern double-hung sash windows. These ca. 2000 windows are the only windows on the building not covered on the exterior. At approximately the same time, ca. 2000, one window was removed from the first story of the northwest wall and infilled with plywood. Two three-part, wood casement windows were boarded on the exterior. The casement windows feature simple interior wood molding, and may be operable.

Northeast Wall

There are no windows located on the northeast wall.

8. Roof

- a. Shape, Covering: The building has a flat roof that appears to be covered with either tar and gravel or a rolled-out rubber material.
- b. Cornice, Eaves: The parapet wall located on the façade has a pediment form that varies in height above the roof level. It projects approximately 9' above the roof line at the center of the wall, and slopes down to approximately 3'-2" in height above the roof level at the east and west ends. The parapet wall is laterally supported by steel bracing members that appear to be channels, which follow the top profile of the wall and are integrated into the wall. There are two diagonal, steel braces comprised of double angle sections on the backside of the parapet wall. The top ends of the braces are bolted to the steel channels, and the bottom ends are likely bolted to the roof deck.

C. Description of Interior

1. Floor Plans:

- a. Basement: The basement is divided into three bays by interior steel columns, and is mostly open, with few wall partitions. Enclosed spaces include a walled-in storage room that may have been a pantry and a walled-in storage room that appears to have been a cold storage. The pantry, which no longer has a door, includes built-in shelving and has no additional finishes or detailing. The cold storage room no longer has a door, is wood-paneled on the interior, and no longer exhibits electrical equipment related to refrigeration.
 - b. Main Floor: The main first floor is divided into three bays via interior steel columns and is predominantly open in plan, with few wall partitions. Though all interior wall finishes have been removed, the first floor retains wall framing that indicates prior interior divisions. Framing indicates that a portion of the first floor, along the northeast wall, was divided into smaller spaces that may have contained offices and a restroom. The age and style of the framing indicates that most of the interior walls were added many years after the building was constructed, likely ca. 1960-70.
 - c. Second Floor: The second floor is divided into three bays via interior steel columns, is open in plan, and does not appear to have been previously divided.
2. Stairways: The building has one interior staircase, which is attached to the northeast wall and connects the basement, first, and second stories. The staircase is wood-framed with concrete steps and wood balustrade, including wood square-edge balusters, handrail, newel posts and caps, landing, and wall and outer stringers.
3. Flooring: Some hardwood flooring remains intact on the first floor. At an unknown date in the mid- or late-twentieth century, linoleum or vinyl tiles were laid over the wood. Most of the tiles were removed, leaving a composite subflooring material across the majority of the first floor. Some linoleum tiles remain, particularly in the east part of the building. The second floor retains its hardwood flooring, though large portions are missing, exposing the wood joists below. The basement floor is concrete.
4. Wall and Ceiling Finish: All of the interior wall and ceiling finishes have been removed, except for a minimal amount of wood paneling that remains in the basement.

5. Openings:
 - a. Doorways and doors: No interior doors remain as the interior has been stripped of finishes and most wall partitions. Within the first story, the wood framing indicates where doors were located, and one frame retains a small amount of the original door casement molding, which is wood and painted green.
 - b. Windows: There are no interior windows.
6. Decorative Features: Very few decorative features remain on the interior of the building due to the removal of nearly all interior features and finishes. A small amount of door casement molding remains in the first story and appears typical of ca. 1930 wood molding with a simple ogee design.
7. Hardware: Door hinges visible on the interior appear to be steel and have raised geometric patterning. Metal chain and lock hardware on transom awning windows remain intact.
8. Mechanical Equipment:
 - a. Heating: There is no indication of the heating system as it has been removed from the building.
 - b. Plumbing: There is no indication of a plumbing system, including any water tanks, heaters, or pumps, and only a minimal amount of original water piping is visible within the interior wall framing.
 - c. Electric: The building has an interior elevator that does not appear to function. The elevator was manufactured by the Reliance Elevator Company of Chicago, Illinois and is mostly steel. There is no visible decorative detailing. The elevator appears to have been used for freight.

A ca. 1930 electrical panel and a surge box are located in the basement. Neither appears to be operational. A few remaining conduit lines are visible within the framing on the interior; however, most of the electrical equipment and all lighting have been removed. A ca. 1970 electrical panel is also located on the first story and does not appear to be functioning.

D. Site:

1. Historic Landscape Design: There is no historic landscaping associated with the building, which resides within a commercial street and is lined along the façade (southeast) with a concrete sidewalk. A parking lot is located northeast of the building in the location that once contained a historic garage, and that parking lot features some modern (ca. 2000) planter boxes adjacent to it within the sidewalk.
2. Outbuildings: There are no historic outbuildings associated with the station building. Historically, a garage was attached to the northeast wall; however, it was removed in 1976, and only a small portion of that building (a hyphen) remains attached to the northeast wall. A modern (ca. 2010) steel-frame, glass enclosed bus and train shelter stands 100 feet east of the station.

PART 3. SOURCES OF INFORMATION

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PART 4. PROJECT INFORMATION

The HABS documentation for the South Shore Station at 114 E. 11th Street in Michigan City is being completed to satisfy the Memorandum of Agreement (MOA) between the Federal Transit Administration and the Indiana State Historic Preservation Officer Regarding the Double Track Northwest Indiana Project (Project), executed December 8, 2017. The Project as proposed by the

Northern Indiana Commuter Transportation District (NICTD) requires the demolition of the South Shore Station, determined eligible for listing in the NRHP under Criteria A and C in the Historic Property Report completed by HDR Engineering, Inc. (HDR) on behalf of NICTD in August 2017. The MOA stipulates that appropriate mitigation for the adverse effect caused by the demolition of the station will be the completion of a HABS Documentation Level II (Outline Form) Report. NICTD has contracted with HDR to complete the HABS documentation for the South Shore Station. HDR architectural historians Diana Garnett, Leesa Gratreack, and Jeanne Barnes completed the historic research and write up for the HABS report. Large format photography was provided by Leslie Schwartz in December 2019.